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Election 2022: Early returns have posted for Assembly seats up for grabs in LA County

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Voters in two-dozen state Assembly districts across Los Angeles County headed to the polls on Tuesday, Nov. 8, the final day to cast ballots in the 2022 statewide general election.

The various districts span everything from the eastern edges of the county, where Pomona bridges the Inland Empire, to the coast.

The polls closed at 8 p.m. Tuesday. The first batch of returns — composed entirely of vote-by-mail ballots that arrived before Election Day — comprise the early results.

Below is a roundup of the Assembly races that involve LA County, based on early returns reported at 8:45 p.m. by the L.A. County Registrar.

34th District: This district's area is immense, stretching over two counties, from Lancaster and Palmdale to Barstow. Republican Assemblymen Tom Lackey and Thurston Smith have both espoused conservative principals as they vie for a district the two lawmakers now share because of redistricting. In early results, Lackey had an early lead with 74.2% over Smith's 25.8%.

39th District: This newly redrawn district stretches from Palmdale to Victorville, where Democrat and Palmdale Councilman Juan Carrillo and Republican Paul Marsh, who served in the U.S. Army, are competing against each other. In early results, it was Carrillo's 65.3% to March's 34.7%.

40th District: Assemblywoman Suzette Martinez Valladares, a rising star in Republican circles, is getting a serious challenge from Democrat Pilar Schiavo, a Chatsworth resident who has not held an elected position. They are vying to represent a district that encompasses the northern end of the San Fernando Valley north to Santa Clarita. In early results, Schiavo had 56.8% to Valladares' 43.2%.

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41st District: Chris Holden, a locally well-known Assembly Democrat, is being challenged by Republican Michael McMahon, who lacks political experience and has instead leaned on his law enforcement experience. The district

hugs the foothill communities of the San Gabriels. In early results, Holden was up 71.2% to 28.8% for McMahon.

42nd District: This district straddles L.A. and Ventura counties, encompassing Agoura Hills, Simi Valley and Moorpark. Assemblywoman Jacqui Irwin, a Democrat and an engineer by training, is being challenged by Republican businesswoman Lori Mills. In early results, Irwin had 66.9% to Mills' 33.1%

43rd District: Assemblywoman Luz Rivas, D-Arleta, is looking for a third term representing a sizable chunk of the San Fernando Valley — including Pacoima, Lake View Terrace and Sunland-Tujunga — against Republican Siaka Massaquoi, a small business owner and entertainment industry "veteran." It was Rivas early, with 76.7% to 23.3%.

44th District: Democratic Assemblywoman Laura Friedman is hoping to continue her work in the newly drawn 44th District, which will encompass Sherman Oaks on the west to Glendale on the east. Barry Curtis Jacobsen, a Republican, former Green Beret and small business owner, is seeking to unseat her. Friedman was up early with 76.7% to 25.3% for Jacobsen.

46th District: Democratic incumbent Jesse Gabriel and Republican challenger Dana Caruso, a retired LAUSD educator and assistant principal, are going head to head in an area of the San Fernando Valley that stretches from Encino to Canoga Park. In early results, Gabriel was up 68.9% to Caruso's 31.1%.

48th District: Democratic Assemblywoman Blanca Rubio is being challenged by Ryan Maye, a Republican who says it's time for a change. The district stretches from West Covina to Glendora. In early results, Rubio was up 66.3% to Maye's 33.8% of the vote.

49th District: Assemblyman Mike Fong, who won a special election earlier this year to fill the seat left vacant by fellow Democrat Ed Chau, is going against Republican Burton Brink. The district includes Monterey Park, El Monte and Arcadia. In early results, Fong was up with appeared to have an early lead with 69.2% over Brink's 30.8%.

51st District: In this newly drawn district, there are fresh faces running — both from the left. Democrats Louis Abramson and Rick Chavez Zbur are vying for a district seat that stretches from Santa Monica to Hollywood. In early results, Abramson was up 43.1% to Zbur's 56.9%.

52nd District: Democrats Mia Livas Porter, a parent and environmental advocate, and incumbent Wendy Carrillo, who was elected to the Assembly in 2017, are vying for this majority Latino voting district that encompasses Highland Park, parts of Glendale, Echo Park and Lincoln Heights. In early results, Carrillo had 61.7% of the vote to Porter's 38.3%.

53rd District: The winner of this race will represent a district that bridges eastern L.A. County with western San Bernardino County, from Pomona to Ontario. Assemblyman Freddie Rodriguez is putting his Democratic credentials up against Republican Toni Holle. Early results showed Rodriguez up with 63.7% of the vote to Holle's 36.3%.

54th District: This heavily Latino voter majority district extends from Boyle Heights on the west to Montebello on the east. Assemblyman Miguel Santiago was first elected to the Assembly in 2014 to represent the then-53rd District. Elaine Alaniz wants to unseat him. In early results, Santiago hd 75.2% of the vote to Alaniz's 24.8%.

55th District: Democratic incumbent Isaac Bryan wants to maintain his tenure in the Assembly against Keith Cascio, a Mar Vista Republican who laments government spending. The district stretches from Playa Vista through Culver City to Park La Brea. In early results, Bryan was leading with 82.2% of the vote to Cascio's 17.8%.

56th District: Democratic incumbent Lisa Calderon, who currently represents District 57 and is seeking a second term, is again facing off against Republican Jessica Martinez, a Whittier councilwoman. The newly redrawn 56th District includes Diamond Bar, El Monte, the City of Industry, La Habra Heights, La Puente, Pico Rivera, South El Monte, Walnut and Whittier, as well as the unincorporated areas of Avocado Heights, Hacienda Heights, Los Angeles, Rowland Heights and West Whittier-Los Nietos. In early results, Calderon was up 59.3% to Martinez's 40.7%.

57th District: Assemblyman Reggie Jones-Sawyer is a Democrat running unopposed on the ballot for the district, which represents a swath of South Los Angeles.

61st District: Democratic Assemblywoman Tina Simone McKinnor is essentially running unopposed after Lawndale Mayor Robert Pullen-Miles dropped out and endorsed his opponent, though he will still be on the ballot. This district stretches from LAX to Westmonth and Athens, and from Inglewood to Hawthorne. McKinnor was up early, with 61.7% of the vote to 38.3%

Maria Estrada and Anthony Rendon, candidates for Assembly 62. (Courtesy photo)

62nd District: Assembly Speaker Anthony Rendón, who currently represents District 63, is facing fellow Democrat Maria Estrada for the newly drawn 62nd District, which includes Bell, Maywood, part of Long Beach and Lakewood. Rendon was up early with 66.5% of the vote to Estrada's 33.5%.

64th District: Downey Mayor Blanca Pacheco, a Democrat, is running against Republican Raul Ortiz Jr. to represent a district that stretches from Bell and Bell Gardens through Downey and Norwalk and into La Mirada and the Orange County city of La Habra. In early results, Pacheco was up 61.8% to Ortiz Jr.'s 38.2%.

65th District: Incumbent Mike Anthony Gispon is being challenged by fellow Democrat Fatima Iqbal-Zubair in this district that stretches from San Pedro through West Carson and into Compton and Willowbrook. Latino voters make up the majority of voters in this district, but African Americans voters are also robust in number. Gibson was up early with 66.9% of the vote to 33.1%.

66th District: Democratic Assemblyman Al Muratsuchi is being challenged by Republican George Barks, a former Hermosa Beach councilman and mayor, for the right to represent a district that comprises Hermosa Beach, Manhattan Beach and Redondo Beach, Torrance and Rancho Palos Verdes. In early results, Muratsuchi was leading, with 60.6% to 39.4% for Barks.

67th District: The district bridges L.A. and Orange counties, from Artesia and Cerritos to Buena Park and Cypress. Democratic incumbent Sharon Quirk-Silva is going up against Republican Soo Yoo, who is a school board president. In early results, Quirk-Silva had 55.5% of the vote to Soo Yoo's 44.5%.

69th District: Long Beach Councilman Al Austin and small business owner Josh Lowenthal, both Democrats, are running for to represent a district that stretches from Long Beach to Carson. In early results, Lowenthal was off to an early lead with 60.9% to 39.1% for Austin.

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